Zen AI Model Family

Zen-Next

Flagship Model

Technical Whitepaper v1.0

Hanzo AI Research Team
research@hanzo.ai

Zoo Labs Foundation
foundation@zoolabs.org

September 2025

Abstract

We present **Zen-Next**, a 80B parameter model optimized for flagship model. Built upon zen-72B, this model achieves state-of-the-art performance while maintaining exceptional efficiency with only 80B active parameters. Supporting 1M thinking tokens for advanced reasoning, the model represents a significant advancement in democratizing AI through sustainable and efficient architectures.

Contents

1 Introduction **2**
1.1 Key Innovations . . . 2

2 Architecture **2**
2.1 Model Design . . . 2
2.2 Technical Innovations . . . 2
2.2.1 Mixture of Experts (MoE) . . . 2
2.2.2 Attention Mechanism . . . 2
2.2.3 Thinking Mode . . . 2

3 Performance Benchmarks **3**
3.1 Evaluation Results . . . 3
3.2 Efficiency Metrics . . . 3

4 Training Methodology **3**
4.1 Dataset . . . 3
4.2 Training Process . . . 3

5 Use Cases and Applications **3**
5.1 Primary Applications . . . 3
5.2 Integration Examples . . . 4

6 Environmental Impact **4**
6.1 Sustainability Metrics . . . 4
6.2 Green AI Commitment . . . 4

7 Safety and Alignment **4**
7.1 Safety Measures 4
7.2 Ethical Considerations 4

8 Deployment Options **5**
8.1 Available Formats 5
8.2 Hardware Requirements 5

9 Future Work **5**
9.1 Planned Improvements 5
9.2 Research Directions 5

10 Conclusion **5**

A Model Card **6**

1 Introduction

The rapid advancement of artificial intelligence has created an unprecedented demand for models that balance capability with efficiency. **Zen-Next** addresses this challenge by delivering enterprise-grade performance while maintaining a minimal computational footprint.

1.1 Key Innovations

- **Efficient Architecture**: 80B active parameters from 80B total
- **Specialized Training**: Optimized for flagship model
- **Extended Context**: 128K context window
- **Thinking Mode**: 1M thinking tokens

2 Architecture

2.1 Model Design

Zen-Next is based on the zen-72B architecture with several key modifications:

Component	Specification
Total Parameters	80B
Active Parameters	80B
Base Model	zen-72B
Context Length	128K
Thinking Tokens	1M
Architecture Type	Transformer

Table 1: Zen-Next Architecture Specifications

2.2 Technical Innovations

2.2.1 Mixture of Experts (MoE)

The model uses a dense architecture with all parameters active during inference, optimized for maximum performance per parameter.

2.2.2 Attention Mechanism

Extended attention mechanisms support up to 128K context length with efficient KV-cache management.

2.2.3 Thinking Mode

Advanced reasoning through extended thinking tokens (up to 1M), enabling:

- Step-by-step problem decomposition
- Self-correction and verification
- Complex multi-step reasoning
- Internal deliberation before response

3 Performance Benchmarks

3.1 Evaluation Results

Benchmark	Score
MMLU	75.6%
HumanEval	61.7%
GSM8K	90.7%
HellaSwag	86.9%

Table 2: Language Understanding Benchmarks

3.2 Efficiency Metrics

Metric	Value
Inference Speed	45 tokens/sec
Memory Usage (INT4)	40 GB
Energy Efficiency	80% reduction
Latency (First Token)	200 ms

Table 3: Efficiency Metrics

4 Training Methodology

4.1 Dataset

The model was trained on a carefully curated dataset comprising:

- High-quality filtered web data (35TB)
- Domain-specific corpora for flagship model
- Synthetic data generation for edge cases
- Human feedback through RLHF

4.2 Training Process

1. **Pretraining**: 5 trillion tokens over 45 days on 64x A100
2. **Supervised Fine-tuning**: Task-specific optimization
3. **RLHF**: Alignment with human preferences
4. **Constitutional AI**: Safety and helpfulness optimization

5 Use Cases and Applications

5.1 Primary Applications

Conversational AI and chatbots

Content generation and summarization

Code completion and review

Educational assistance

Research and analysis

5.2 Integration Examples

```
from transformers import AutoModelForCausalLM, AutoTokenizer

# Load model and tokenizer
model = AutoModelForCausalLM.from_pretrained("zenlm/zen-next-80b-instruct")
tokenizer = AutoTokenizer.from_pretrained("zenlm/zen-next-80b-instruct")

# Generate response
inputs = tokenizer("Explain quantum computing", return_tensors="pt")
outputs = model.generate(**inputs, max_length=100)
response = tokenizer.decode(outputs[0])
```

Listing 1: Basic Usage Example

6 Environmental Impact

6.1 Sustainability Metrics

- **Carbon Footprint**: 0.45 kg COe per million inferences
- **Energy Usage**: 10.2 kWh per day (1000 users)
- **Efficiency Gain**: 80% reduction vs comparable models

6.2 Green AI Commitment

Zen AI models are designed with sustainability as a core principle, achieving industry-leading efficiency through architectural innovations and optimization techniques.

7 Safety and Alignment

7.1 Safety Measures

- Constitutional AI training for harmlessness
- Comprehensive red-teaming and adversarial testing
- Built-in safety filters and guardrails
- Regular safety audits and updates

7.2 Ethical Considerations

The model has been developed with careful attention to:

- Bias mitigation through diverse training data
- Transparency in capabilities and limitations
- Privacy-preserving deployment options
- Responsible AI principles alignment

8 Deployment Options

8.1 Available Formats

- **SafeTensors**: Original precision weights
- **GGUF**: Quantized formats (Q4_K_M, Q5_K_M, Q8_0)
- **MLX**: Apple Silicon optimization (4-bit, 8-bit)
- **ONNX**: Cross-platform deployment (coming soon)

8.2 Hardware Requirements

Precision	Memory	Recommended Hardware
FP16	160 GB	2x A100 80GB
INT8	80 GB	A100 80GB
INT4	40 GB	RTX 4090

Table 4: Hardware Requirements by Precision

9 Future Work

9.1 Planned Improvements

- Extended context windows (up to 1M tokens)
- Enhanced multimodal capabilities
- Improved efficiency through further optimization
- Expanded language support

9.2 Research Directions

- Advanced reasoning mechanisms
- Self-supervised learning improvements
- Zero-shot generalization enhancement
- Continual learning capabilities

10 Conclusion

Zen-Next represents a significant advancement in AI democratization, delivering exceptional performance for flagship model while maintaining unprecedented efficiency. Through innovative architecture design and careful optimization, the model achieves a balance between capability and sustainability that sets a new standard for responsible AI development.

Acknowledgments

We thank the open-source community, our research partners, and the teams at Hanzo AI and Zoo Labs Foundation for their contributions to this work.

References

A Model Card

Field	Value
Model Name	Zen-Next
Version	1.0.0
Release Date	September 2025
License	Apache 2.0
Repository	huggingface.co/zenlm/zen-next-80b-instruct
Documentation	github.com/zenlm/zen
Contact	research@hanzo.ai

Table 5: Model Card Information